Loops: repeat the pattern

Programming · Level 1 · Lesson 2



Today we will

- Spot repeated steps and turn them into a loop.
- Compare two programs by how many cards they need.
- Explain why a loop is easier to change.

Remember

- A loop says the steps once, and how many times.
- Shorter, clearer, and one number to change.
- Repeat n times, for each item, or until something happens.

Clap the loop

1. Warm-up (5 min): Clap a pattern; pupils copy it.
2. Teach (10 min): Write it in full, then as a loop.
3. Create (10 min): Groups invent a pattern and write both versions.
4. Perform (10 min): Groups perform; the class checks the loop.
5. Wrap-up (5 min): Which version is easier to change? Exit ticket.

Noisy but worth it: a pattern pupils perform is a loop they remember. No device is needed.

Let’s discuss

1. Why is a loop easier to change than the full version?
2. Which loops do pupils already know from songs and games?
3. When is a loop not worth it?

Exit ticket

- Write a pattern as a loop, and say how many steps it saves.